

A SAMPLE LESSON

The Foundation

BOOK ONE · GRADES K-2

Unit 1 · Lesson 1 — “Who Am I?”

THE ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE · CURRICULUM

School of Life Foundation

Who Am I?

20–25 min · Week 1 · First Lesson of the Year

OBJECTIVE	Students name at least two things about themselves and understand every person in the class is unique.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness — identifying personal qualities and positive self-concept.
VOCABULARY	who I am · special · unique · strength · different
MATERIALS	Drawing paper · crayons · large identity web poster · Sammy puppet

SAFETY CHECK · BEFORE CLASS

Confirm Sammy is in his permanent spot. Practice the Kind Coach voice once. This is the first lesson — the tone you set today shapes the rest of the year.

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

“I want to know all about YOU! Can you tell me one thing that makes you special?”

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · 5 STEPS

1

Introduce Sammy 3 MIN

Take two minutes to introduce Sammy before any content. Let students meet the puppet and feel the tone. Sammy says hello to each student by name. The classroom learns to anticipate Sammy as a regular presence.

IN-LESSON SCAN

After Sammy greetings, scan the room. Any child who did not respond may need a gentle individual check-in. Note for Teacher Reflection — do not address publicly.

2

Build the Identity Web 7 MIN

Draw a large web on the board — centre circle says “ME.” Five branches: Things I Love · Things I’m Good At · Things That Make Me Happy · Something Special About My Family · Something People Might Not Know About Me. Build one branch at a time. Model with your own answers first.

3

Individual Webs 8 MIN

Students draw their own mini identity web on paper. Circulate with warmth — every web is valid, every answer is right.

IN-LESSON SCAN

While circulating: any student staring at blank paper for more than 2 minutes — crouch down: “Tell me one thing you love, I’ll write it for you.” Do not press publicly.

4

Share Circle 5 MIN

Each student holds up their paper and shares ONE thing of their choosing. They never have to share more than they want to. Sammy responds warmly to each share.

5

Establish the Compact 2 MIN

After the share circle, begin the Classroom Compact. “What do we need to feel safe in this space?” Collect 3–5 answers, post permanently. (See Section 1.6 for the full Compact protocol.)

KINDERGARTEN

Teacher circulates and writes dictated words while the student draws. Pointing to a drawing is enough. Verbal sharing is optional.

GRADES 1–2

Students write simple labels independently. Encourage specifics: not “I like animals” but “I like my dog Max.” Share one favourite branch.

EXIT TICKET

Thumb up if you feel like the class knows one true thing about you today. Sammy gives a thumbs-up to every hand — no commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students struggled to name anything — defaulting to silence? This is early data about self-perception that will matter all year. Note quietly.

SAFETY CHECK · POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT

Any child who did not engage at all — flag for a gentle individual check-in before Lesson 2. Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up? ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today.

FAMILY CONNECTION · A NOTE HOME

Today we began the year by celebrating who your child is. Ask at home: “What is one thing you would put on YOUR identity web?” Listen without correcting. Every answer is right.

THIS LESSON INCLUDES

Anchor Chart

Drawing Activity

Scenario Cards

Drawing Example

END OF THE SAMPLE LESSON

One of 28 lessons across four units.

The Foundation · Book One of The Architecture of Grace · Grades K–2